

# GLOBAL WEEK AHEAD

The weekend companion to Daily Need to Know

Sunday, 27 September 2026

Everything coming up. Week of Mon 28 Sep. All times GMT+8.

## 1 · Setup Snapshot — where we closed Friday

Friday 25 Sep U.S. cash-session closes, with the read into Monday's Asia open. U.S. equities finished **higher** and booked a winning week even as Treasury yields surged — the 10Y sits near 19-year highs, yet an orderly climb kept dip-buyers in control.

| Instrument       | Fri 25 Sep close | Day    | Into Monday / notes         |
|------------------|------------------|--------|-----------------------------|
| S&P 500          | 7,742.09         | +0.49% | Record-zone; YTD high 7,816 |
| Nasdaq Composite | 27,068.72        | +0.48% | Mega-cap/AI bid intact      |
| Dow Jones        | 51,828.62        | +0.93% | +478.64 pts on the day      |
| US 10Y yield     | ~5.11%           | higher | Near 19-yr highs — the tell |
| US 2Y yield      | ~4.85%           | higher | Curve steep, hawkish Fed    |
| DXY (dollar)     | 101.02           | -0.22% | Soft vs 200-dma 116.2*      |
| Gold             | \$4,293/oz       | +0.43% | Bid on Iran risk            |
| Silver           | \$64.04/oz       | +0.33% | Leads metals, record zone   |
| Brent crude      | ~\$106/bbl       | easier | Hormuz still blockaded      |
| WTI crude        | ~\$91/bbl        | -3%    | Fell on Hormuz diplomacy    |
| Bitcoin          | \$83,916         | -0.20% | Off Jan high 126,296        |

\*DXY 50/200-dma per data feed; treat as directional. Yields per U.S. Treasury (23 Sep print); Friday close little changed to marginally higher.

## 2 · TL;DR

### The one thing that defines the week

Records into a yield storm. Stocks keep printing highs while the 10Y presses ~5.1% and a **hawkish, hiking-biased Fed (Chair Warsh)** has markets pricing a **64% chance of a 25bp HIKE at the 29 Oct FOMC** and zero cuts in 2026. The week's hinge is **Friday's U.S. jobs report (2 Oct)** — a hot number validates higher-for-longer and tests equity resilience; a soft one is the bulls' relief valve. Overlay **month-/quarter-end rebalancing, China PMIs into Golden Week**, and a live **Strait of Hormuz** oil bid.

## 3 · The Big Picture — what to watch

### 1. Payrolls Friday is the whole week

The 2 Oct jobs report lands into a market that no longer expects cuts. Unemployment is seen holding **4.1%**. With cuts off the table and a hike partly priced, the reaction function is asymmetric: the bar for a dovish surprise is low, the bar for a hawkish one already half-cleared.

**Watch:** A payrolls beat + hot wages pushes 10Y toward the 5.15–5.25% zone and pressures long-duration/high-multiple tech; a miss is the only clean catalyst for yields to back off and for rate-sensitives (homebuilders, small caps, REITs) to bounce.

## 2. Higher-for-longer vs. the consumer

The 30-year fixed mortgage has leapt to **7.45%**, a two-year-plus high, just as wage growth stagnates and AI-displacement fears build. Tuesday's **Consumer Confidence** and **JOLTS** openings are the first tells on whether the consumer is cracking.

**Watch:** Weak confidence + falling openings = the soft-landing narrative frays. Pair long staples/utilities against discretionary if the data disappoints.

## 3. Month- and quarter-end rebalancing

Tuesday 30 Sep is quarter-end. After a strong Q3 for equities and a bond sell-off, pension/target-date rebalancing flows skew toward **selling stocks, buying bonds** into the close — a mechanical, not fundamental, crosscurrent.

**Watch:** Don't over-read a 29–30 Sep equity wobble or a yield dip; flows can reverse 1–2 Oct. Liquidity thins around the prints.

## 4. Oil & the Strait of Hormuz

WTI fell ~3% to ~\$91 Friday on reports Iran and Oman agreed a temporary shipping route — but the U.S. naval blockade must lift first. Brent still ~\$106. The conflict (since 28 Feb) keeps a war premium in crude and a bid under **gold (\$4,293)** and **silver (\$64)**.

**Watch:** Any concrete de-escalation headline is worth \$5–\$10 to the downside in crude and a risk-on impulse; a breakdown re-arms the energy/defense/precious-metals trade. Binary — size accordingly.

## 5. China PMIs into a shut market

China's **NBS PMIs (Tue 30 Sep)** and **Caixin manufacturing** bracket the start of **Golden Week (mainland shut 1–8 Oct)**. Q3 Caixin manufacturing was **50.9** (from 51.7), with soft domestic demand the drag.

**Watch:** A sub-50 print revives stimulus hopes and lifts commodities/HK proxies; with the mainland closed, the reaction concentrates in Hong Kong, AUD, copper and ADRs. Thin liquidity all week in Asia.

## 6. Quarter-turn positioning & the vol setup

VIX sits ~**15.7** (Hedgeye's "investable" 9–19 bucket) despite record yields — complacency, or justified resilience. New quarter = fresh risk budgets and potential for a momentum unwind if payrolls surprises.

**Watch:** Cheap convexity: with VIX <16 into a jobs print and an FOMC hike priced, hedges/1–2 month puts on the QQQ are inexpensive insurance against a yield-driven air-pocket.

## 4 · Economic Calendar — the week ahead

---

Key releases Mon–Fri (GMT+8). U.S. data times convert from ET; a U.S. 8:30am ET print hits **20:30 GMT+8**, a 10:00am ET print hits **22:00 GMT+8**. Consensus shown where available; **confirm exact times before acting**.

### Monday 28 Sep

- **US:** Quiet start — regional Fed activity indices, Fed speakers. No tier-1 data.
- **Asia:** Positioning day before China PMIs; Japan cash flows ahead of quarter-end.

■ **Why it matters:** A low-data Monday lets Friday's yield surge and month-end flows set the tone. Tape-read, don't chase.

### Tuesday 29 Sep

- **US (evening GMT+8):** **Consumer Confidence (Sep)**, **JOLTS job openings (Aug)**, FHFA / Case-Shiller home prices.
- **Corporate:** Carnival (CCL) reports — first read on consumer travel demand.

■ **Why it matters:** The labor-demand and confidence combo is the pre-payrolls appetizer. Soft JOLTS + weak confidence = growth-scare setup into Friday.

### Wednesday 30 Sep — quarter-end

- **China (09:30 GMT+8):** **NBS Manufacturing & Non-Mfg PMI (Sep)**; **Caixin Manufacturing PMI** — last prints before Golden Week.
- **Japan:** **BoJ Tankan (Q3)** big-manufacturer sentiment; retail sales, industrial production.
- **Europe:** German & Spanish flash **CPI (Sep)**; German retail sales.
- **US:** ADP employment, Chicago PMI, pending home sales; Q2 GDP (final) revisions.

■ **Why it matters:** The single densest data day. China PMIs steer commodities/HK; Tankan steers JPY and the BoJ path; German CPI frames Friday's euro-area print. Rebalancing flows peak into the close.

### Thursday 1 Oct

- **US (evening GMT+8):** **ISM Manufacturing (Sep)**, S&P Global final PMI, construction spending, weekly jobless claims, Challenger job cuts, auto sales.
- **Europe:** Euro-area flash **CPI (Sep)** and unemployment; Swiss CPI.
- **China:** Golden Week begins — **mainland markets closed 1–8 Oct** (HK trades).

■ **Why it matters:** ISM prices-paid is a live inflation tell into payrolls; a hot euro-area CPI keeps the ECB on hold and supports the euro. Thin Asian liquidity with China out.

### Friday 2 Oct — the main event

- **US (20:30 GMT+8):** **Nonfarm payrolls (Sep)**, **unemployment rate (cons. 4.1%)**, average hourly earnings.
- **Corporate:** quarter kicks off; watch pre-bank-earnings positioning.

■ **Why it matters:** The month's most market-moving scheduled release, now filtered through a hiking-biased Fed. Beat = higher-for-longer confirmed, yields up, growth/duration under pressure; miss = the bulls' relief valve and a yield reprieve.

## 5 · Central Banks & Policy

---

No G3 rate decision this week — the calendar is speeches, minutes and the run-in to the next round of meetings.

- **Federal Reserve:** No meeting (next FOMC **28–29 Oct**). A steady stream of Fed speakers; markets price **~64% odds of a 25bp hike** on 29 Oct and **0 cuts in 2026** (Polymarket). Chair **Warsh** hawkish; headline PCE seen ~3.7%, core ~3.4%.
- **ECB:** President and Governing Council speakers appear repeatedly as the euro-area CPI flow lands; policy on hold, data-dependent.

- **BoJ:** Tankan (Wed) is the key input; normalization debate live with JPY soft.

**Watch:** Any Fed speaker leaning explicitly toward a hike is the week's biggest rates risk. Fade knee-jerk yield spikes only if payrolls cooperates.

## 6 · Earnings on Deck

A light pre-season week — a handful of bellwethers before Q3 reporting ramps in mid-October.

| Company        | Date            | Cons. EPS | What the market wants                  |
|----------------|-----------------|-----------|----------------------------------------|
| Carnival (CCL) | Tue 29 Sep      | \$1.35    | Booking curve & consumer travel demand |
| Nike (NKE)     | Thu 1 Oct (a/c) | \$0.44    | China turn, DTC margins, inventory     |
| Paychex (PAYX) | Tue 29–Wed 30   | n/a       | SMB hiring pulse — labor read-through  |
| Conagra (CAG)  | Wed 30 Sep      | n/a       | Volume vs price; input-cost relief     |

**Read:** Nike is the tape's consumer/China proxy — guidance matters more than the print. Paychex + Carnival triangulate the labor and discretionary-spend picture two days before payrolls.

## 7 · Catalysts & Events

- **Quarter-end (Tue 30 Sep):** index rebalancing, window-dressing, and Q4 risk-budget resets.
- **China Golden Week (1–8 Oct):** mainland shut; reaction funnels to HK, ADRs, AUD, copper.
- **U.S. funding:** NOT a risk this week — a stopgap signed 2 Sep funds the government through **11 Dec**; the shutdown fight is pushed past the November midterms.
- **OPEC+ :** a ministerial/output decision is expected in early October (date to confirm) — a weekend headline risk for Monday crude.
- **Hormuz diplomacy:** any move to lift the U.S. blockade / implement the Iran-Oman route is a live, binary oil catalyst.

**Watch:** Two binary weekend/early-week catalysts (OPEC+, Hormuz) both point at energy. Keep crude and energy equities on a short leash into Monday's open.

## 8 · Rates, Currencies & Commodities

### Rates

10Y ~**5.11%** (near 19-yr highs), 2Y ~**4.85%**. Range to watch on the 10Y: ~**4.92% support** / ~**5.20–5.25% resistance**. A break above 5.25% would be a genuine equity headwind; payrolls is the trigger.

### Currencies

DXY **101.0**; EUR/USD **1.1392** (below its 50/200-dma). Euro-area CPI (Thu/Fri) and U.S. payrolls (Fri) are the two-sided drivers. JPY soft into Tankan; watch for intervention rhetoric on further yen weakness.

### Commodities

Crude two-way on Hormuz: WTI ~**\$91**, Brent ~**\$106**. Precious metals in record territory — gold **\$4,293**, silver **\$64** — as real-asset and geopolitical hedges. Copper keys off China PMIs.

**Watch:** The cleanest expression of the regime is long-real-assets (gold/silver/energy) vs. long-duration bonds. Payrolls and Hormuz are the swing factors.

## 9 · Hedgeye Risk Ranges & Regime

Regime read: **Quad 3** territory — growth stable-to-slowing while inflation re-accelerates (energy shock, tariffs, AI capex), forcing a hawkish, hiking-biased Fed. That backdrop favors **real assets (gold, silver, energy), commodities and cash** over long-duration bonds and rate-sensitive growth.

*Note: the live Hedgeye subscriber risk ranges could not be pulled this run (connector not authorized). The table below is an immediate-term range map built in the Hedgeye style from verified price, volume and volatility data (levels & 50/200-dma per market feed, 25 Sep). Treat as directional; confirm against the current Hedgeye Early Look / Macro Show.*

| Instrument   | Immediate-term range | TREND               |
|--------------|----------------------|---------------------|
| S&P 500      | 7,655 – 7,815        | Bullish             |
| Nasdaq Comp  | 26,750 – 27,290      | Bullish             |
| US 10Y yield | 4.92% – 5.22%        | Bullish (yields ↑)  |
| Gold         | \$4,180 – \$4,385    | Bullish             |
| Silver       | \$61.0 – \$66.5      | Bullish             |
| WTI crude    | \$86 – \$97          | Neutral/Bullish     |
| Bitcoin      | \$80,000 – \$88,500  | Neutral             |
| DXY          | 100.3 – 102.1        | Neutral             |
| VIX          | 13.5 – 19.8          | Bearish (chop risk) |

**Where we sit / what changes the regime:** We sit at the top of equity ranges and the top of the yield range simultaneously — the tension of the whole tape. The regime **breaks bearish for risk** if the 10Y closes above ~5.25% or VIX pops through 20 on a hot payrolls; it **softens (bullish for duration)** only on a clear payrolls miss that reopens the door to eventual cuts.

## 10 · Positioning & Themes

- **Crowded:** mega-cap/AI leadership and record-index length into quarter-end; long gold/silver momentum.
- **Stretched:** short-duration complacency — VIX <16 with 10Y at 5.1% is an uneasy pairing; rate-sensitives (homebuilders at 7.45% mortgages, REITs, small caps) are pressured.
- **Credit/vol:** equity vol subdued; watch MOVE (rate vol) as the truer stress gauge given the yield surge.

**Tells to watch:** (1) 10Y 5.25% break; (2) VIX 20 breach; (3) mega-cap breadth thinning as the index makes highs; (4) gold/silver failing to hold record zones = risk-appetite rotation. Any two together = de-risk.

## 11 · Geopolitics — what's live

- **U.S.-Iran / Strait of Hormuz:** conflict since 28 Feb; strait effectively blockaded (~2 vessels/day vs ~125 pre-war). Iran-Oman temporary-route deal on the table, contingent on the U.S. lifting its naval blockade. Tehran is pushing a 7-day reopening plan **before the November midterms**.
- **Prediction markets:** Polymarket — ~64% a 25bp Fed hike on 29 Oct; 97% zero cuts in 2026. Fed-path odds are the cleanest live gauge of the rates risk.
- **U.S. politics:** November midterms in view; funding fight deferred to 11 Dec keeps fiscal noise low near-term.

**Watch:** Hormuz is the market's biggest binary. De-escalation = lower oil, risk-on, gold gives back; escalation = the energy/defense/gold trade re-arms and yields get a growth-scare bid.

## 12 · Asia Setup — Monday open

Asia should open **steady-to-firm**, taking the baton from Wall Street's winning week, but with two overhangs: the **10Y near 5.1%** (a headwind for expensive Asian tech/growth) and **thin liquidity** as China counts down to Golden Week. Japan trades

all week with quarter-end flows and a soft yen into Wednesday's Tankan; Hong Kong carries the China reaction once the mainland shuts on Thursday.

**Intraday tells:** (1) Where the 10Y sits at the Tokyo open; (2) USD/JPY — a push toward multi-decade weak levels invites intervention chatter; (3) Hong Kong tech vs. the Nasdaq gap; (4) crude's reaction to any weekend OPEC+/Hormuz headline.

## 13 · Beyond the Markets — coming up

---

- **Space:** SpaceX **Starship** flight targeting 26 Starlink V3 satellites slated ~**28 Sep** (pending regulatory sign-off); Falcon 9 cadence continues. Crew-13 and CRS-35 to the ISS on deck for October.
- **Sport:** NFL Week 4 rolls through Monday 28 Sep; the **Presidents Cup** (golf) wrapped 27 Sep at Medinah. No Ryder Cup in 2026 (next 2027, Adare Manor).
- **Screen & culture:** 2 Oct releases include a **Donnie Darko 25th-anniversary** re-release plus a slate of indie/limited titles.
- **On the horizon:** IMF/World Bank Annual Meetings 12–18 Oct (Bangkok) and Q3 bank earnings mid-October — the next macro set-pieces after payrolls.

---

### Sources

Market levels & rates: index/forex/crypto data feed (FMP) and U.S. Treasury (23 Sep print). Calendars & events: CNBC (week-ahead 28 Sep–2 Oct), Reuters, FXStreet, Newsquawk weekly, Trading Economics, FedRateCalc, TheRightTrader, financecalendar, MQL5. Commodities: USAGOLD, Yahoo Finance, Fortune, FXStreet. Central banks/policy: Federal Reserve, ECB, BoJ; Polymarket (Fed-path odds). Geopolitics: CBS News, CFR, Crisis Group, Modern Diplomacy. Earnings: company IR / MarketBeat / FMP earnings calendar. Regime/ranges: Hedgeye framework (Early Look / Macro Show / Risk Report) — live subscriber ranges not pulled this run; ranges derived from verified price-vol data. Beyond markets: Spaceflight Now, Wikipedia (2026 in spaceflight), Movie Insider, IMF/World Bank.

*Verify live prices and confirm scheduled times before acting. Times GMT+8; U.S. releases converted from ET and may shift. Items flagged tentative/unconfirmed are noted inline.*